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(From left) **Siddharth Zarabi**, Editor, *Business Today*

Sandip Patel, MD, IBM India and South Asia



"Technology as a *sutradhar* (facilitator)" — that was the theme of the conversation, in which Patel said AI is bringing technology closer to people adding AI has the power to democratise technology for the masses



Patel said that according to him, AI is more of an augmented intelligence, which can help people. "...It (AI) is clearly something that actually enables you to make better decisions, to be a lot more informed, and that can happen in any part of the society, whether it is urban or rural areas. In fact, it's in the rural areas that you can do a lot more with it," Patel said



Speaking about the youth of the country and their employability, Patel said, "If you look at the demographic dividend, in about two or three years, we will have the largest volume of employable youth in the country. If that demographic is skilled appropriately, we can truly become the skill capital of the world for not only AI, but for any kind of technology"

